Your free community magazine

thamesview

www.gallionsha.co.uk

Issue 3 Summer 2007

Trust Thamesmead's Summer Festival



Inside this issue



Prize Draw Winner

Meet the Stars

Summer with the wardens

Gallions Housing Association

From Your Editorial Team

Over the coming summer months there's so much to do around and about that we're sure you haven't got enough days to fit it all in!

One day you can't afford to miss is this year's summer festival. This year there's more great acts, special events and lots to take part in – guaranteed fun for all the family.

This month's edition of Thamesview has been produced with the help of our new sub editors, made up of Gallions staff and residents. We're always looking for features to include and feedback so if you have anything you would like us to know contact our editorial assistants.

Enjoy the summer and see you at the festival.

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Complaints Contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A guide is available on the Gallions website under the 'quick links' section on the front page. You may also get in touch with the Complaints Management team who will advise you what action to take. Your feedback is important to Gallions.

complaints@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk
0800 838481

Careers at Gallions

Details of our current employment opportunities are publicised on our website www.gallionsha.co.uk and at our reception desk. Please do get in touch if you are interested in a career with us.

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH; tel: 0800 838481; fax: 0870 458 0227; web: www.gallionsha.co.uk and is free to residents of Gallions' homes and anyone else who wishes to obtain a copy.

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ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਜੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਦੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਦੇ ਇਹ ਫਾਰਮ ਲਿਸੇ ਲਿਫਾਫੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

Punjabi ○ Chinese ○ Vietnamese ○
(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

_____

Return to: Joanne Scott, Translation Requests,
Gallions Housing Association,
Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

A New Look for Gallions Housing Association

Over the next few months you will begin to see a new look to Gallions information. We have changed to create a recognisable and meaningful look to tie in with the new Thamesmead Vision. Hopefully helping to showcase Thamesmead for all its qualities, such as open spaces, parks and lakes.

We also have changed our look to ensure that all communication is clear and easy identifiable and more cost effective to print. You will see changes to our signboards, leaflets and uniforms, including Team Gallions.

Please contact Emma Turner on 020 8320 3552 if you have any comments or questions about the new look or communication in general.

How good is our housing management service?

Gallions is providing a good service to residents and is on track to improve even further, according to the government body (Audit Commission) that inspects all housing providers in England. We are very pleased with the outcome as a bad result would have meant less funding from the government to develop new properties and maintain the standard of service we provide to you.

In putting together the results, the Audit Commission looked at, amongst other things, the quality of our service and compared the results against other housing providers. All providers are assessed in the same way so making comparisons are easier. The results now put Gallions in the top 25 per cent of all housing associations in the country. Not bad!

Inspection is a tough exercise and we really had to be geared up for it. In addition to talking to staff and looking at the way we carried out our work, the inspectors also interviewed a random sample of residents and called on a few to ask how good or bad they found our service. So as you can see, somewhere along the line, you too had a part to play in our success.

Here are some of the things the inspectors identified as our strengths:

- Knowledgeable and helpful staff providing strong customer care and access
- A focused and effective approach to diversity
- Effective repairs and maintenance of properties
- Well developed rent collection procedures
- Dealing proactively with anti-social behaviour

A full copy of the report will be available on our web site along with the executive summary.

For more information contact Mike Robinson our Service Improvement manager on 0800 838 481.

STATUS SURVEY – JANUARY 2007

The last survey was carried out in 2004, so the 2007 survey shows us were we have improved and where we need to make further changes to give you a better service.

1. Satisfaction with the overall service has improved from 75.9% to 76.5%.
2. Generally residents in Bexley are happier with services than those in Greenwich.
3. 79% of residents are happy with repairs and maintenance.
4. Residents satisfaction with the final outcome of the contact with Gallions has increased from 63% to 70%
5. 84% of residents said that they were happy with being kept informed by Gallions.
6. Satisfaction with 'crime problems' has improved generally across the whole area. These problems include issues such as vandalism, graffiti, rubbish and other crime.

Recommendations from the survey that we will be working on to improve include:

Improving the overall quality of the housing stock and residents in Parkview, Southmere and Lesnes in particular would like to see an improvement in the neighbourhood.

One key area of concern was that opportunities to participate were unclear. 47% are happy with the service, 6% are unhappy, but 47% either have no opinion or don't know. So we need to improve ways to participate.

If you would like to get more involved contact Helen Chambers on 0800 838 481.

DIRECT DEBIT – A WINNER FOR EVERYONE

Congratulations to Miss Jarvis of Marshall Path who was the winner of the April draw and all she had to do was pay her rent by direct debit!

Miss Jarvis won £100.00 vouchers from a store of her choice in Bexleyheath and opted for M&S vouchers.

The next draw will take place on July 20th 2007 so for more details of how you can pay by direct debit and be entered into the draw simply call 0800 838481 and speak to the Credit Control team.



Gallions Residents Board News and Information

Keep an eye out in your post for details of Gallions Residents Board elections which take place in July. This is your opportunity to decide who will represent residents in Gallions formal consultations. Results will be published in the next edition of Thamesview.

Gallions Residents Board will be holding their Annual General Meeting on Wednesday 29th August 2007 in the Community Resource Centre, Harrow Manor Way, SE2. The meeting is open to all Gallions residents, please contact Helen Chambers, GRB Officer 0800 838481 ext 382, if you would like to attend.

Gallions Residents' Board



GET TO THE FRONT OF THE QUEUE

At Gallions we know how frustrating it can be to be kept waiting on the phone – that's why we now operate a 24 hour, 7 day per week call centre service.

The busiest times for our call centre are between 8am - 10 am, 12noon -2pm and late afternoon so if you don't want to be kept waiting just call out of these peak times.

If you do need to call during a peak time, but can't wait, we also have a call back option so that you can leave a message for any non-urgent enquiries and a member of the team will phone you back within 24 hours.

0800 83 84 81

GAS SAFETY - DON'T TAKE A CHANCE

Servicing your boiler is very important as leaks or problems can make your bills higher than necessary and even dangerous to you and your family. Therefore at Gallions we need to ensure that all gas appliances, fittings and flues that we own, and you use, are serviced annually. These checks take about half an hour depending on the number of our gas appliances in your home.

It is vital for your safety that you allow us to service your boiler by giving our contractors (Interserve Facilities Services) access to have the servicing done. If you do not allow us access we will have to take court action and any costs incurred will be passed on to you (as well as the cost of missed appointments).

If you are a Gallions Housing Association tenant (not leaseholders or freeholders) and you are aware that your boiler has not been serviced in the last year, please telephone Carol Rayner on 0208 320 3559 to make an appointment as soon as possible.



GOING UP

After a selection process involving resident feedback, Precision Lift Services is now our Lift Replacement and Maintenance contractor. They have a 10 year partnership contract to combine general lift maintenance as well as delivering a programme of renewing and replacing lifts.

Precision are looking to employ new staff from the community as part of their trainee lift engineer programme – would this interest you?

If so, please apply by sending your CV to
Ian Reynolds, Managing Director
Precision Lift Services Ltd
Precision House, Unit 10 Upminster Trading Park
Warley Street
Upminster
Essex
RM14 3PJ

HAVE YOUR SAY

We would like to invite you to give us your views about the services provided by Gallions.

There are a number of ways you can give us your views including:

- Joining a focus group: for example to look at, how quickly repairs are carried out, how we help keep Thamesmead tidy etc.
- Become a quality inspector: You would inspect the quality of work in homes to make sure it is of an excellent standard, look at the quality of different services and then report back to the Gallions Resident Board.

Training would be provided so if you are interested in getting involved then please call Helen Chambers, GRB Officer on 0800 838481 for more information.

Neighbourhood Wardens Out and About

Take a walk on the wild side with Phil Briggs

With plenty of open spaces, lakes and rivers, Thamesmead has more than its fair share of wild life and some of it is closer than you think.



Frogs,
toads, newts, hedgehogs,
lizards, birds, ladybirds, snakes and slow worms
can all be found right on your doorstep. All of these animals are protected so please don't try to get rid of them from your gardens. Try to encourage them especially if you are a keen gardener as they will eat the pests that can damage your plants. If possible dig a small shallow pond to encourage the animals into your garden and have a log pile to attract hedgehogs and give other animals somewhere to hide.

Most of all have fun watching the animals you attract and let us know about the animals that you spot.

Down on the Farm with Peter Uings

Our warden, Peter, has been busy this month helping out the Tri Angle Nursery with their trip to Woodlands Trust Farm in Shooters Hill. Peter has passed a mini bus driver course and is now qualified to use the Bexley Accessible Transport service which involves driving minibuses for community activities.

The nursery kids enjoyed running about in the woods looking for animals including a pond full of insects, frogs and birds. After lunch the kids went to a huge field on the farm for a few games run by the helpers. By the time the coach got back to the nursery most of the little ones were fast asleep completely tired from their fun day out.

The minibuses are available for community transport and are all equipped to a high standard for use by children and adults. Contact Peter for more information.

Ear about our new service

Until recently those of you with hearing aids could get tubes and batteries replaced at your local surgery or pharmacy, but now you will have to go to Queen Elizabeth's drop in clinic on a Monday for this service (you will need to ring before you drop in though).

However for those of you who find it difficult to get out Peter has been trained to replace these tubes and batteries and has an emergency supply in the office and he's happy to help where possible.

Queen Elizabeth Hearing aid clinic can be contacted on 0208 836 5326/5333.

Healthy Eating Project with Bruce Bishop

Over the last few months Bruce has been entertaining and educating over 900 kids in local schools with healthy eating cooking lessons. Lynton Mead and Hawksmore are the next lucky schools that Bruce will be showing off his Jamie Oliver type skills. If your school would like to take part then call Bruce for more details.



Are you stumped for something to do?

This summer we are running a young persons cricket club in Thamesmead. If you are aged between 10 to 16 years we need you for the team. We will be playing other teams once we have a full team set up and trained. If you are interested or know anyone who is then please call 0208 320 3431, simply leave your name, address and phone number and we will get back to you with more details.

If you want to find out more about any of the features on this page call the Neighbourhood Wardens on 0800 838481.

A Vision for Thamesmead at the Residents Conference

Woolwich Polytechnic School in Thamesmead.

The guest speaker for the day was Professor Richard Scase who was the author of the Thamesmead Vision. Over 40 residents attended to hear about the Thamesmead Vision plus talk to Gallions staff about services and improvements in general.



The conference was certainly a very good chance for residents to learn more about the Vision and to contribute ideas as to how we can work together to achieve it.

At the conference residents had the chance to take part in workshops including:

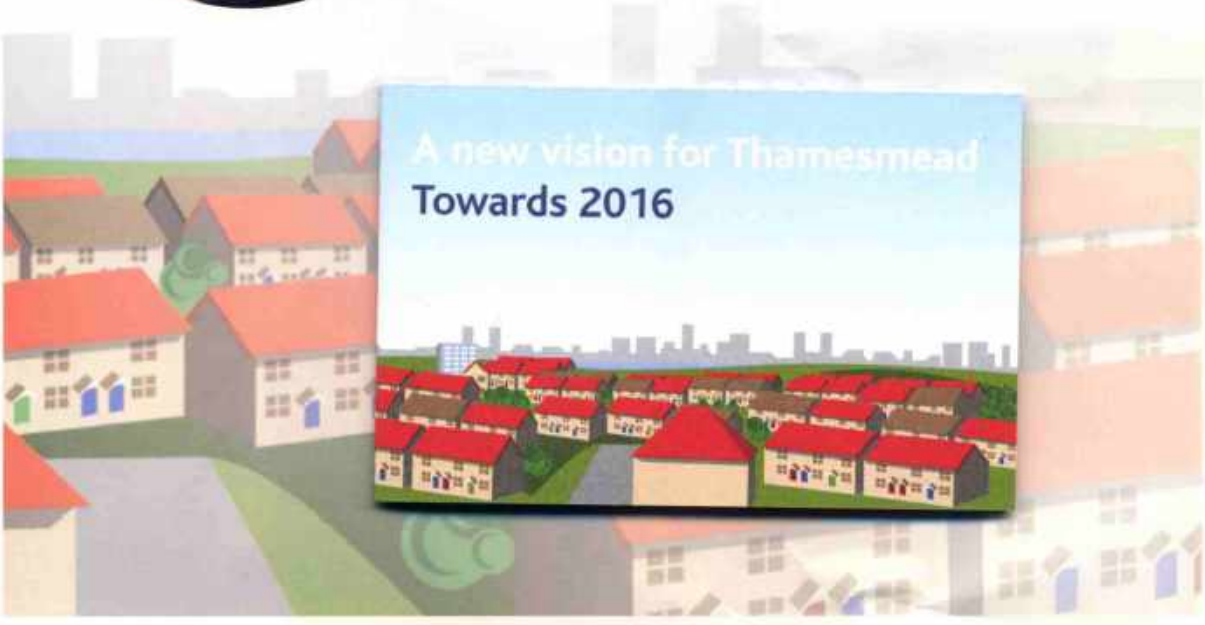
- Tackling Crime and Fear of Crime
- Activities for Young People
- Making the most of Thamesmead's Green Spaces
- Getting to Know your Neighbours
- Making Sense of your Money



The workshops gave residents the opportunity to highlight their concerns and suggest how, by working together, we can resolve some common issues and create a better Thamesmead.

Thank you to everyone who attended and took the time to give us their views. Over the coming months we will be feeding back on how the vision is progressing and any future projects that are a direct result of the vision and the residents' conference.

If you weren't able to attend you can still give us your thoughts on the vision. The vision is there to ensure we shape and build a future for Thamesmead and we can only do this with your help. Below you will find a summary booklet which outlines the vision. Please let us know what you think by contacting the Neighbourhood Projects Team on 0800 838481



GET READY FOR THAMESMEAD'S EVENT OF THE YEAR

This year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival is taking place on Saturday 14 July in Birchmere Park and is set to be a truly amazing event with more headline acts and activities going on than ever before.

The free event will not only feature a main stage with a whole host of celebrities – Jamelia, Showaddywaddy, The Real Thing, Antony Costa, Sybil, The Honeyz and Thamesmead's very own Trust Thamesmead T Factor winners Audio Hawk but also a circus, circus workshops, a Treasure Island Beach, a Festival Parade featuring 400 local children, an activity fun zone and a Trust Thamesmead birthday party marquee celebrating Thamesmead's 40th birthday.

So get into the groove and head on down! This is your invite to the party of the year!

We aren't the only ones getting excited about this year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival...

"I hope everyone from the community attends this fantastic free event. I can't wait to celebrate Thamesmead's 40th birthday with everyone."
- Antony Costa

"We promise you a great live show, full of hits and a lot of dancing - you'll be out of breath watching. We really can't wait to perform in Thamesmead."
- Eddie, The Real Thing

"You can't beat playing outdoors to a huge crowd who are singing your song on a nice summer's day. It's priceless."
- Celina, The Honeyz

"We have seen the line-up - it is a very different bill of artists, celebrating the last 40 years of music. We can't wait!"
- Dave, Showaddywaddy





SUMMER FESTIVAL

TRUST.
THAMESMEAD

CELEBRATE THAMESMEAD'S 40TH BIRTHDAY
SATURDAY 14 JULY 2007
10AM - 8PM
BIRCHMERE PARK

Free event

ENJOY LIVE ACTS REPRESENTING FOUR DECADES OF POPULAR MUSIC WITH...

Jamelia
Showaddywaddy
Antony Costa
The Real Thing
Sybil The Honeyz

Circus Big Top
Treasure Island Beach
Festival Parade
Birthday Party Marquee
Activity Zone Children's Zone

www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk/festival
T 020 8320 4470

The Music Stage

Your comperes today are ITV X-Factor Finalist ***Nikitta Angus*** and Trust Thamesmead's very own ***Danny Thorpe*** and ***Graham Bignell***.

Greenwich Youth Orchestra 1:00
Triquetra 2:15
The Blues Brothers Uncut 2:40
The Real Thing 3:05
Martelé 4:00
Danielle Staras 4:35
The Honeyz 5:00
Sybil 5:30
Showaddywaddy 5:50
Antony Costa 6:20
Audio Hawk, T Factor winners 6:55
Jamelia 7:10
Thank you and Goodnight 8:00

Please Note: Running order subject to change

Festival Parade

Get ready to samba as up to 400 local children open the festival with this year's Trust Thamesmead carnival, celebrating Thamesmead's 40th birthday with a parade from Linton Mead Primary School (starts 12:00). Meet there and parade into Birchmere Park carnival-style.

Treasure Island Beach

Shiver your timbers and join the pirates who will be taking up residency on our Treasure Island. Whether you're shooting for coconuts, swimming in the lagoon, relaxing under a palm tree or hunting for treasure, Gallions Housing Association promises fun for all the family.

Activity Zone

Come and have fun in the festival Activity Zone, where there are loads of things to do to keep you entertained. Do you have what it takes to make it through the Army's assault course? Fancy reaching new heights at the cAve climbing wall? With activities for all the family, be sure to stop by here during your visit.

Children's Zone

Plenty of fun to be had in this year's Children's Zone with so much to do including: Wild West Inflatables; Dolphin Bouncers; Trampolines; Games Area; Face Painting; Puppet & Kite workshops; Arts & Crafts; Festival Train.

Birthday Party Marquee

An all-day birthday party celebrating 40 years of Thamesmead with: Arts and Crafts; Balloon Modelling; Glitter Tattoo Artist; DJ and a Flashing Dance Floor.

Let's Get This Party Started! 12:00

Funky Disco Dance Competitions 12:30
medals and prizes to be won

Acrobatic Disco Dance Show 1:00
followed by disco dance workshop

Pass the Parcel and Piñata Time 1:30

Crazy Crackerjack Competition 2:00
with prizes and cabbages!

Limbo and Hoola-Hoop Competitions 2:30

Acrobatic Disco Dance Show 3:00
followed by disco dance workshop

60's and 70's Karaoke Competition 3:30

Pass the Parcel and Piñata Time 4:00

Crazy Crackerjack Competition 4:30
with prizes and cabbages!

Acrobatic Disco Dance Show 5:00
followed by disco dance workshop

Limbo Competition and Arts & Crafts Prize-giving 5:45
prizes for 1st, 2nd & 3rd place

Circus Big Top

The magic of the circus comes to the festival for the first time this year with a 500-seater big top. Don't miss this fast-moving and spectacular show with lots of circus skills: Daring Trapeze, Amazing Juggling, Dazzling Acrobatics and, of course, the Circus Clowns.
(No need to book; queues may form; limited capacity)

Shows (45mins) 12:00; 2:00; 3:45; 5:15
Workshops (45mins) 12:45; 2:45; 4:30

I-Zone

Fancy a festival chill-out? Well, what better way to do it than taking a stroll around the I-Zone. If the excitement is getting too much for you why not stop off at the health stand and get your blood pressure checked? The Community Village showcases many local groups who will be promoting their activities. They'll either try to get you to join or part with your money as they raise funds for their activities.
Or why not drop in to Greenwich Council's *Talk Café* to have your say & find out about local services.

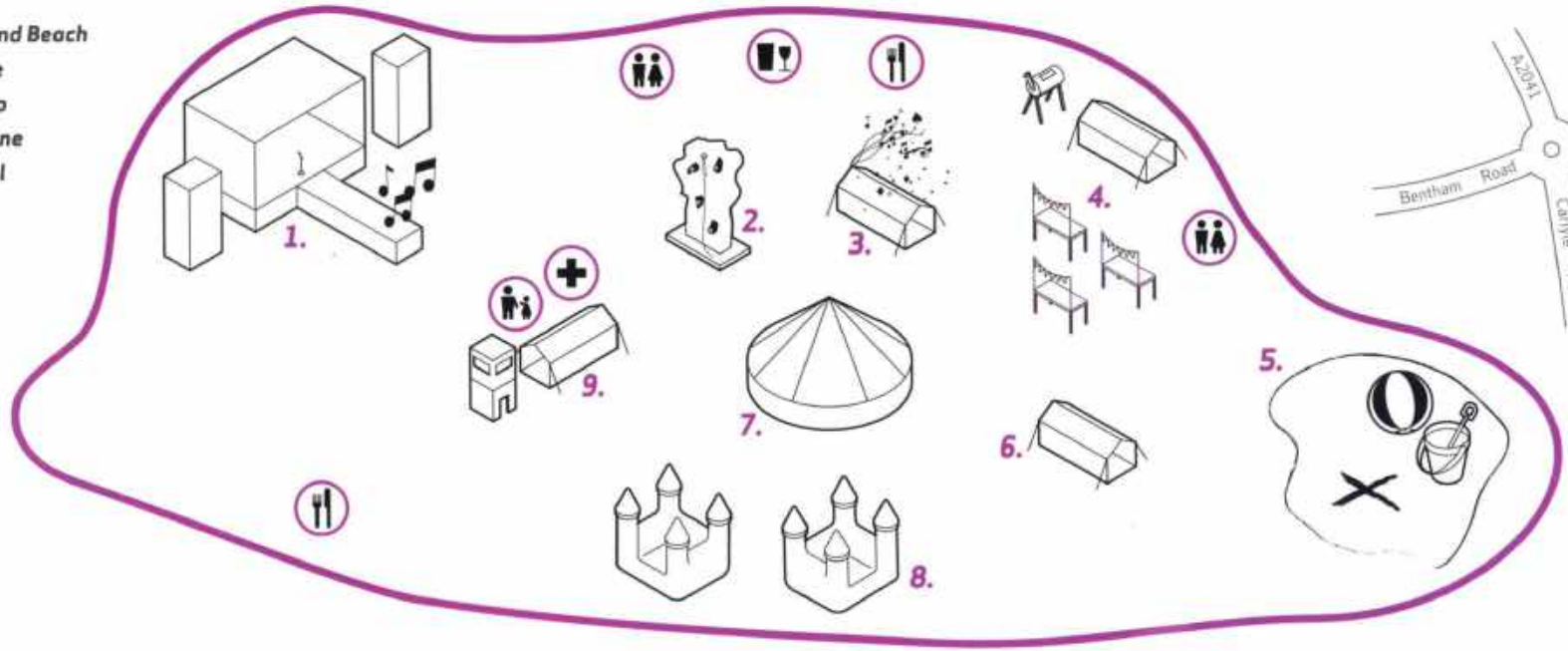
trust-thamesmead.co.uk

ENJOY THE FESTIVAL

Site Plan

What's What...

1. Music Stage
2. The cAve Mobile Climbing Wall
3. Birthday Party Marquee
4. The I-Zone
5. Treasure Island Beach
6. Activity Zone
7. Circus Big Top
8. Children's Zone
9. Event Control



How to get here

By bus: B11, 472 and 244 stop close to Birchmere Park (at the junction of Bentham Road and Southwood Road).

177, 229 and 401 stop in Thamesmead town centre, just a five minute walk (approx) from Birchmere Park.

By train: Nearest station Abbey Wood (buses connect to festival site)

Public parking

Located in Glendale Way, access to Southwood Road for Pass Holders and Disabled Blue Badge Holders only. Easy pedestrian access to site via footpath from **FREE parking** off Glendale Way.



Please note:

Dogs, alcohol and glass bottles are not permitted within the site. Barbeques are strictly prohibited. These and any glass bottles will be removed by stewards. A licensed bar is available.

Stewards are on site throughout the day. If you have any questions or experience any problems during your visit please contact a member of staff.

By attending Trust Thamesmead's Summer Festival you are agreeing to be filmed and/or photographed for marketing purposes.

The information contained in this programme was correct at the time of publication. Whilst every effort will be made to deliver the advertised programme, the festival organisers cannot be held responsible for any subsequent changes that may be necessary owing to operational or technical reasons.

Public Toilets · First Aid · Lost Children

Food Courts · Tavern

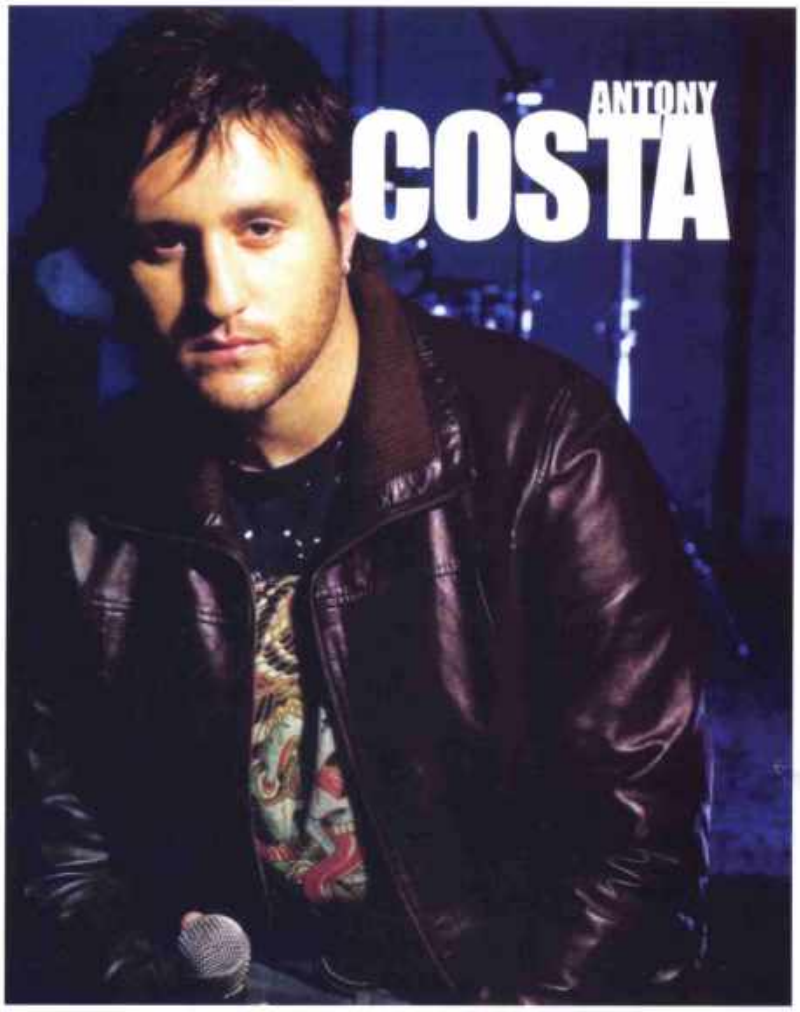
Trust Thamesmead - Supporting our environment
Printed using vegetable inks on recycled materials

Greenwich Council · Bexley · Tilfen · AXIS · Gallions

Trust Thamesmead would like to thank all festival sponsors, the Metropolitan Police and the London Boroughs of Bexley and Greenwich for their support.

TRUST. THAMESMEAD

Antony Costa looks forward to the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival



Hi Antony! You have just finished a tour of Boogie Nights – how was it?

It was a great but gruelling six month tour. I loved being able to play a part that allowed me to use my signing and acting skills and become someone else for the night. What kept it alive was the crowd – each one brought something extra to the show.

Are you looking forward to playing at this year's Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival?

I am really looking forward to it. It is going to be amazing – I have never played in front of so many people as a solo artist, so I am sure I will be nervous but hopefully that will turn into adrenaline. It is going to be about the energy and I have spoken to Simon (Webbe) who headlined last year – he said the crowd was amazing and he's given me some tips, so I'm raring to go.

Have you been to Thamesmead before?

I have visited the area a few times with Lee (Ryan) - he lives up the road in Blackheath. I remember Thamesmead being very green – I might have even been to Birchmere Park.

Will you miss the other boys from Blue when you are on stage?

It will be strange not having the boys bopping away behind me and feeding off their energy but when you're on stage the performance takes over and you forget everything and give it your all.

If you could choose to duet with anyone who would it be?

The one person I would love to duet with is George Michael. He's been my hero since I can remember. I try and take inspiration from him as his music has lasted throughout the decades - that is the making of a superstar.

What is next for you?

Having just finished a 12 month stint in theatre – six months Blood Brothers followed by six months of Boogie Nights, I feel it's time for a long summer holiday. Somewhere nice and hot.

Treasure Island with Gallions



When going to the festival this year make sure you don't miss out on Gallions Treasure Island. Join in with staff as we search for pirates, hunt for buried treasure and soak up the sights and sounds of this fun packed island beach.

And you never know you might just end up walking the plank...we look forward to seeing you me hearties.....

COMPETITION! Your chance to meet the stars



If you are aged 14 or under then this is your chance to win a VIP passes for you and two friends to meet the stars* backstage at Trust Thamesmead's Summer Festival.

To win just answer this question:
Which Thamesmead park is this years Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival being held?
Is it:

a) Southmere Park
b) Birchmere Park
c) Crossway Park

Fill in the answer slip below along with your details and return by 10th July 2007.

You must have a guardian (aged 18+) with you when going backstage to meet the stars so please make sure you leave their details below as well.

Winning entries will be pulled out of a hat and winners will be notified by telephone on Wednesday 11th July.

* Who you meet depends on the days schedule.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Telephone No. .....

Name of guardian responsible for you on the day: .....

Your Answer: .....

Return to: Sam Ladipo, Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH (or drop into Gallions reception).

Tour de France
Sunday 8th July 2007

The Tour de France, is more than simply a French affair. Each year the first leg of the event starts somewhere different, either in France or another country and this year it's coming to London and Kent.

Whilst its going to be a great day with lots of parties and events to celebrate it does mean that some roads will be closed on the day of the event and surrounding roads are likely to be busy too.

The roads being used for the route will be closed from around 6am to 1pm so you will not be able to get across these roads during that time.

Listed below are roads near the Thamesmead and Abbey Wood area that are affected as well as an easy reference map:



©TFL All maps courtesy of Transporrt for London

ROAD	AREAS CLOSED
Woolwich Road	From Bostall Hill to Erith Road
Erith Road	From Woolwich Road to Fraser Road
Fraser Road	From Erith Road to Bexley Road
Bexley Road	From junction with Fraser Road to roundabout with Walnut Tree Road and Queen's Road South
Queen's Road South	From roundabout with Walnut Tree Road and Bexley Road to Northend Road
Northend Road	From Queen's Road South to roundabout with Thames Road and Perry Street
Thames Road	From roundabout with Northend Road and Perry Street to roundabout with University Way and Burnham Road

Reading can reach everyone with the Home Library

Bexley Library Service, run by local volunteers, provides a free home library service for Bexley residents who are unable to get out of their home to visit their local library.

Library books, paperbacks, large print titles and talking books on cassette tape or CD's can be delivered straight to your door.

If you would like to request this free service or you would like to be considered as a volunteer, please contact Elaine Lapham by email elaine.lapham@bexley.gov.uk or call 0208 309 4165.

Young People

Toy Library

Linton Mead Junior & Infants Mixed School
Central Way
Friday 9am-11am
Under 5s
Term time only
Tel: 020 8310 1902

Thamesmead Chess Club

Tenants' Resource Centre
Harrow Manor Way
Friday 7pm-11pm
Free entry for children and students
£1 for Adults
Contact: Peter Houching
Tel: 020 8516 9619 / 07875 563248

Cave Climbing Wall

Thamesmead's climbing wall is an excellent way to learn a new skill or to improve on your climbing technique. **www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk Tel: 0208 320 4494**

Fun Club

Glimpsing Green
Saturday morning fun for children up to 11 who have a disability or a special need.
Tel: 020 8311 6777

Brownies

Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 7 to 11
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Guides

Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 11+
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Greenmeade Community Hall

- *Carer & Child Drop-in*
- *Sunshine Club for children with autism*

Tel: 0208 303 1006

Rainbows

Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 5 - 7
Tel: 0208 310 3496

Brownies

Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 7 to 11 years
Tel: 0208 244 3488
07958 967902
e. sandy.white70 @ntlworld.com

New Acres Library Tavy Bridge

Tel: 020 8311 5291

- *Baby Time*
  Nursery rhymes, singing, stories for the under 4's and their parents.
- *Family Learning*
  For children 5 + years and their parents.
- *Story Time*
  For children 3 to 5 years and their parents.
- *Teenage Reading Group*
  Fun activities to help teenagers discover books.

Music and Dance

Dynamix

Church of the Cross Hall
Lensbury Way
Street dance classes ages 8 to 19
Tel: 07796450093

Theatre Street

Broadwater Village Hall
Gooseander Way
Dancing, singing and drama
Tel: 01322 441977
Web: www.theatrestreet.com

Youth Advisory Project

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
Music for 16 to 24 years old
Tel: 020 8311 5111

Clubs and Groups for the Elderly

Monday Club Bingo

Jubilee Hall
Lytton Strachey path
Mondays 2pm-4pm
Tel: 020 8311 5707

Over 50's Bingo Club

Chubby Browns Cafe
Lime Row
Monday and Thursday
7.30 to 9pm
Tel: 020 8310 0240

Pop-In Parlour

Evenlode House
Variety of activities available for the over 55s including a Bowling club, meals every day and Bingo Monday and Wednesday evenings.
Coralline Walk
Tel: 020 8310 7437

Teeswater Atrium

Variety of groups and activities 7 days a week Including Bingo, darts, sewing, ballroom and line dancing and an African social group.
Contact: Denis Thompson-Mason
Tel: 0208 333 2002

Exercise for the over 50's
Wednesday 4.30 - 5.30pm
Tel: 0208 333 2002

After School Clubs

Hawksmoor Youth Club

Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8312 4022

Heronsgate Club

Whinchat Road
Tel: 07950612826

Playgroups

JMF Support Group

Drop-in centre for parents who have children with disabilities. Children can play and parents can chat over a cuppa.
Saturday 1pm-3pm
Jubilee Hall, Lytton Strachey Path
Contact: Mrs Bailey
Tel: 020 8310 5885

Goose-e-ganders

Parent and Toddler group.
Tel: 07958 640645

Toddles

Manor Close Community Hall
Manor Close
Tel: 020 8310 9004

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School

Senior Citizens Hall,
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 07950 853481

Lighthouse Parent & Toddler Group

Emmanuel Church Hall,
Wed / Fri 1.30 - 3.00pm
Tel: 020 8312 4700

To list your group or to let us know any changes.
Please contact: Joanne Scott
020 8320 3409

Show us your green bits

For those of you who are steering clear of bikes then don't forget there's always walking! Whether it's a just a stroll you fancy or an exploration of the greener side of the capital then the Green Chain Walks are for you.

There are thousands of events and activities taking place on the Green Chain Open Spaces throughout the year from horse and carriage rides at Woodlands Farm to music festivals on Plumstead Common, open house days at Severndroog Castle and boating at Southmere Lake.

For more information about events along the routes visit www.greenchain.com or call your local council tourist information centre.

Greenwich Tourist Information Centre 0870 6082000
Bexley Tourist Information Centre 01322 558 676

make a difference

Walkabouts, Meetings and Surgeries

Join us on monthly walkabouts in your area to identify problems and concerns that you have. These will be followed by a meeting to agree the best way of tackling the issues and improving the environment. Make a difference in your neighbourhood - come and tell us where the problems are and work with us to make improvements. If you are unable to come along but would like to speak to your Neighbourhood Co-ordinator, please call them on 0800 83 84 81.

AREA and NEIGHBOURHOOD CO-ORDINATOR	ACTIVITY	DATE AND TIME	LOCATION
Lesnes Pearline Adams	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	5th July, 2nd August, 6th September, 4th October 1st November, 6th December 2-3pm Same as above (3-4pm), Wednesday. 2-5pm	Barge Pole PH GHA Offices Tavy Bridge Office
Parkview and Greenmead Bho Thind	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	9th Aug, 13th September, 11th October, 8th Nov 11th December 2-3pm and 3-4pm, Wednesday. 9-1pm	Atrium, Teeswater Court Same as above Tavy Bridge Project Office
Southmere and Crossway Aaron Nicholson	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	12th July, 9th August, 13th September, 11th Oct 8th November, 13th December 2-3pm Same as above 3-4pm, All Day Thursday	Crossway- Boiler House Southmere- Hartslock Drive GHA offices for both Tavy Bridge Office
Manorway and Moorings Maria Needham	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	4th July, 1st Aug, 5th September, 3rd October 7th November, 5th December. 2-3pm Same as above. 3-4pm, Fridays 10am-2pm (Moorings and Waterfield)	Titmuss Ave Police Station Tump 53 Owen Close
Broadwaters Maria Forber	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	31st July, 28th August, 25th September 30th October, 27th November, 18th December 2-3pm Same as above 3-4pm, Wednesdays 10am-3pm	Whinchat Rd Shops Village Hall 9 Tor Grove
Waterfield Felicity Dunmal	Walkabout Meeting Surgery	11th July, 28th August, 25th Sept, 10th October , 14th November 12th December 2-3pm Same as above 3-4pm, Fridays 10am -2PM (Moorings and Waterfield)	Disraeli Close Tump 53 Owen Close

TAKE A BREAK

The race is on this month so to celebrate the cycle race coming to Thamesmead we've dedicated this months wordsearch competition to the Tour de France. Complete our wordsearch and you could win £25 WHSmith vouchers.

BEXLEY
CANTERBURY
CLOSURE
FRANCE
GREENWICH
KENT
LONDON
ROAD
TOUR
TOWERBRIDGE
WESTMINSTER
WINNER

E	L	D	O	G	R	E	E	N	W	I	C	H	T	U	E	N
S	T	L	E	Y	C	B	E	S	I	L	R	R	C	R	R	I
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L	S	E	W	B	T	T	Y	R	U	B	R	E	T	N	A	C
I	R	E	E	E	H	X	A	E	L	S	A	F	O	E	R	L
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C	O	W	C	X	W	B	T	I	W	N	O	N	R	E	R	I
Y	I	H	Y	E	R	E	E	R	D	N	O	S	L	G	D	S
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R	R	C	I	N	R	W	S	H	N	N	R	W	O	E	U	G
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C	Y	I	O	L	C	L	E	G	D	I	S	N	C	E	A	R
N	W	E	S	T	M	I	N	S	T	E	R	O	R	S	N	B

Name

Address

Telephone

Just send in your correctly completed wordsearch, along with your name and address by 20th July to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, SE2 9XH or drop your entry into Gallions reception. The winners name will be pulled out of a hat.

Congratulations to our lucky winner from the last edition who was: Ms Owusu of Portmeadow Walk.

LOCAL Listings

Chemists

Whinchat Chemist
1 Whinchat Road,
Tel: 0208 333 5000

A F Browne Chemist
4 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 310 7209

Churches

Christian Life Centre
11 Arnott Close
Tel: 020 8310 5361

St Paul's Ecumenical Church
Bentham Road,
Tel: 020 8310 6814

Titmuss Avenue
Baptist Church
85 Titmuss Avenue
Tel: 020 8310 1683

Power Light Evangelism
Tenants' Resource Centre
Harrow Manor Way
Tel: 0208 310 9149
powerlightevang@aol.com

Open Gateway United Church
62-64 Battery Road
Tel 0208 836 9069

Dentists

Gallions Reach Dental
Anaesthetic Clinic
Heronsgate Dental Centre
1b Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8316 6313

Vijay Vithani
12 Joyce Dawson Way
Tel: 020 8311 9400

Lakeside Dental Practice
69 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0844 4778966

Doctors

Heronsgate Medical Centre
1a Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8333 5050

Gallions Reach Health Centre
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8333 5000

Lakeside Health Centre
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 08444 778966

Hospitals

Queen Elizabeth Hospital
Stadium Road, Woolwich
Tel: 020 8836 6000

Queen Mary's Hospital
Frognal Avenue, Sidcup
Tel: 020 8302 2678

Transport

National Rail Enquiries
Tel: 08457 484950

London Travel Information
Tel: 020 7222 1234

ASB HOTLINE 0208 3203441 ASB HOTLINE

Reporting anti-social behaviour

You can report anti-social behaviour either on-line at Gallions website

- **www.gallionsha.co.uk**
- **telephone freephone 0800 838481**
- **speak to a neighbourhood warden**

However you choose to report it, Gallions will do something about it.

If undelivered please return to: Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH



HEY!

I'M MAX AND I'M A NEW MEMBER OF THE GALLIONS' TEAM. I'VE BEEN HAVING LOTS OF FUN LATELY MEETING SOME NEW FRIENDS IN THAMESMEAD AND HOPE WE CAN BE FRIENDS TOO. I'VE MADE UP THIS COMIC SO YOU CAN PLAY GAMES AND QUIZZES AND LEARN ABOUT SOME NEW ART IDEAS – I HOPE YOU ENJOY IT. I HAVE MY OWN WEBPAGE AT WWW.GALLIONSHA.CO.UK WITH PHOTOS, THINGS TO DO AND COMPETITIONS SO CHECK IT OUT! YOU CAN EMAIL ME ABOUT ANYTHING AT MAXTHELION@GALLIONSHA.CO.UK TOO!

YOU'LL SEE ME AT LOTS OF GALLIONS EVENTS SO DON'T FORGET TO SAY HELLO!

Fun Comes First!

TRY AND SPOT THE 4 DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE PICTURE OF THE TWINS BELOW.



Make Me!

TAKE
1 COFFEE JAR LID
8 COLOURED BALLOONS
STICKY TAPE
A4 GREEN PAPER OR CARD (YOU CAN COLOUR ANY PAPER GREEN IF YOU LIKE)

TURN A COFFEE JAR LID INTO A STUNNING SUNFLOWER IN AN INSTANT

1. BLOW UP EACH OF THE BALLOONS A QUARTER OF THE WAY AND TIE A KNOT IN THEM.

2. WITH THE TAPE, STICK THE BALLOONS EQUALLY AROUND THE COFFEE LID WITH THE KNOTS HIDDEN INSIDE THE LID. LEAVE A 4CM GAP FOR THE STALK.



3. CUT GREEN PAPER INTO 6 STRIPS OF 3CM WIDE.



4. TAKE 2 STRIPS AT A TIME AND STICK THE ENDS TOGETHER. THEN FOLD THE STRIPS OVER EACH OTHER TO GET A CONSATINA EFFECT. DO THIS TO BOTH SETS OF STRIPS AND THEN STICK THEM TOGETHER TO MAKE A LONG STALK.

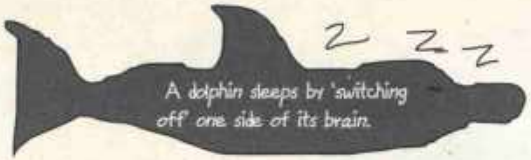
5. STICK THE STALK TO THE GAP IN THE LID AND YOU WILL HAVE A SENSATIONAL SUNFLOWER!



Answers to the Spot the Difference: Hats, Scarf, Buttons and Boots

all, Manor Close, telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Cool days out!



WHY NOT TRY ONE OF THESE EXCITING ACTIVITIES DURING THE HALF TERM HOLIDAYS?

GET CREATIVE AT A SPOOKY HALLOWEEN WORKSHOP:

AT THE WORKSHOP YOU WILL DISCOVER HOW TO MAKE HALLOWEEN LAMPS AND EERIE MASKS. YOU WILL ALSO LEARN HOW TO PLAY CREEPY GAMES. YOU CAN FIND OUT ABOUT THE TRUE MEANING OF HALLOWEEN AND LISTEN TO OLD STORIES AND LEGENDS.

FOR GROWN UPS: THIS IS A FREE EVENT SUITABLE FOR CHILDREN AGED 5+, WHO ARE ACCOMPANIED BY AN ADULT. THE EVENT TAKES PLACE ON 27TH OCTOBER AT CHARLTON HOUSE. CONTACT GREENWICH COUNCIL ON 0208 856 3951 FOR MORE DETAILS.

LEARN TO CLIMB AT THE CAVE INDOOR CLIMBING WALL

DURING HALF TERM THE CAVE IS OFFERING SPECIAL COURSES TO BRING OUT YOUR ADVENTUROUS SIDE:

BASIC THREE DAY COURSE, £20
10:00-12:00 MONDAY, TUESDAY, WEDNESDAY (INCLUDING CLIMBING SKILLS, ABSEILING SKILLS, BELAYING AND LEARNING SAFETY RULES AND ABOUT ROPES AND METALWORK).

INTERMEDIATE TWO DAY COURSE, £15
10:00-12:00 THURSDAY AND FRIDAY (INCLUDING LEARNING TO CLIMB WITH COWS TAILS, ADVANCED CLIMBING, LEAD CLIMBING AND USING DIFFERENT PIECES OF EQUIPMENT TO BELAY AND ABSEIL).

FOR GROWN UPS: CONTACT THE CAVE, ARCH 3, HARROW MANOR WAY, PHONE 0208 320 4470, WEB TRUST-THAMESMEADCAVE.CO.UK FOR MORE DETAILS.

DISCOVER LIFE ON THE HIGH SEAS

THE NATIONAL MARITIME MUSEUM IN GREENWICH IS THE PERFECT PLACE TO UNCOVER THE TALES OF THE SEAS. FIND OUT ABOUT PIRATES, TREASURE AND BIG SHIPS.

FOR GROWN UPS: ENTRANCE TO THE MUSEUM IS FREE. CONTACT THE NATIONAL MARITIME MUSEUM, GREENWICH, LONDON, SE10 9NF, PHONE 0208 312 6565, WEB NMM.AC.UK.

Fish have been around for 500 million years

Enjoy an extra hour in bed and turn clocks back by an hour.

raise money for new game

COOL COMPETITION!

Put safety first and you could be a winner

ALL YOU HAVE TO DO IS FIND THE EXTRA WORD FROM THE LIST. TO FIND OUT WHAT IT IS, READ THE ARTICLE IN THAMESVIEW WITH A PARENT AND FILL IN THE BLANK SPACES BELOW.

ONCE YOU KNOW THE EXTRA WORD, WRITE IT ON THE ENTRY FORM WITH YOUR NAME, ADDRESS AND PHONE NUMBER. PLEASE RETURN YOUR FORM TO US BY 12TH NOVEMBER 2007 SO WE CAN SELECT THE WINNER AT RANDOM FROM THE CORRECT ANSWERS RECEIVED.

CHOOSE FROM THESE WORDS OR SET OF NUMBERS TO COMPLETE THE SENTENCES:

FALL 999 SWIMMING HEAD LIFEJACKETS PARENTS CANOE



MAX AND HIS DAD WERE HAVING FUN SAILING A BOAT ON THE LAKE. FOR SAFETY THEY WERE BOTH WEARING _____.

"DON'T PLAY AROUND THE CANAL'S EDGE," SHOUTED MAX'S MUM, YOU MIGHT _____ IN.

DIVING INTO SHALLOW WATER IS VERY DANGEROUS. YOU MIGHT HIT YOUR _____ ON ROCKS BELOW.

IF YOU SEE ANYONE IN DANGER, YOU SHOULD CALL _____.

MAX'S PARENTS WANT HIM TO LEARN HOW TO SWIM AND BE SAFE AROUND WATERWAYS SO THEY HAVE BOOKED HIM SOME _____ LESSONS.

MAX ALWAYS TELLS HIS _____ WHERE HE IS GOING AND WHEN HE WILL BE BACK.

Please enter your details and the leftover word from the above quiz for your chance to win a family entrance ticket for up to 4 people to the London Aquarium with £30 spending money.

Missing Word: _____

Name: _____ _____

Name of parent or guardian: _____ _____

Address: _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

Telephone: _____ _____

Gallions Housing Association

This competition is open to children under 11 years of age and is free to enter. Return your form to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH by 12th November 2007.

Event

Energy Saving Week 22-28 Oct

Energy Saving Week is a great time to think about your impact on the environment. There are lots of easy ways you can reduce your energy consumption: saving you money and helping prevent climate change.

Need more details? Visit www.energysavingtrust.org.uk or www.gallionsha.co.uk for top energy saving tips. You can also call free energy saving trust advice line on **0800 512012.**

St Andrews Day concert 30 Nov

Trinity College of Music are offering a free concert to mark St Andrews Day at Charlton House. Expect marvellous music and Scottish specialities.

Need more details? Call Greenwich Council on **0208 850 6435**

munity Hall, Manor Close,

re-School, Senior Citizens
950 853481

dler Group, Emmanuel
12 4700, Wednesdays and

rimary school, Central
, Friday 9am until 11am,

telephone 0208 311 5707, Monday 2pm until 4pm

Over 50s Bingo Club, Chubby Brown's Café, Lime Row, telephone 0208 310 0240, Monday and Thursday 7.30pm until 9pm

Pop in Parlour, Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, telephone 0208 310 7437, Wednesday, for the over 55s

The Atrium, Teeswater Court, telephone 0208 333 2002, 7 days a week

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs or groups listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

ow Manor Way,
trust-thamesmead-
m until 7pm and
for under 18s.

ephone 0208 311
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ll, Lytton Strachey
aturday 1pm until

ensbury Way, tele-
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ty Centre, 4 Knee
nesday 4.45pm

e Cross, Lens-
or girls aged 7+.

ephone 0208 311
to teenagers.

oad, telephone

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Way, telephone

, Gooseander
estreet.com, tots

ing Association,
111, for 16 to 24

Strachey Path,
ntil 4pm

Café, Lime Row,
hursday 7.30pm

lline Walk, tele-
over 55s

0208 333 2002,

mmend any clubs or
date information but
ccurate information



Nov

End of British Summer Time 28 Oct

Enjoy an extra hour in bed and turn clocks back by an hour

7

9 Nov

Auction of Promises 10 Nov

Second Belvedere Brownies will be holding an Auction of Promises to raise money for new games equipment. The auction, being held at St ll in Belvedere, begins at 6.30pm and is free and ude beauty hampers and homemade cakes.

ail Brown Owl on **01322 440 071.**

e Sunday 11 Nov

Bazaar 17 Nov

and visit the Christmas Bazaar being held at entre, Lumley Close in Belvedere. The Bazaar is n and 3pm and costs only 20p to attend. There handmade cards and specialist items.

ail Smardon Resource Centre on **01322 432 212**

rmers Market 18 Nov

avours at Eltham Farmers Market. There will be a e and arts and crafts products available for you to the family and have a great day out.

ail Greenwich Council on **0208 850 6435**

s Day concert 30 Nov

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